One fixed variable usually brings the ℓ = 7 draws back to degree 4

These are the results of `research/dreg_closure_specialise_20261017/`; the full text is in `RESULTS.md`. **Class:** stage diagnostic.

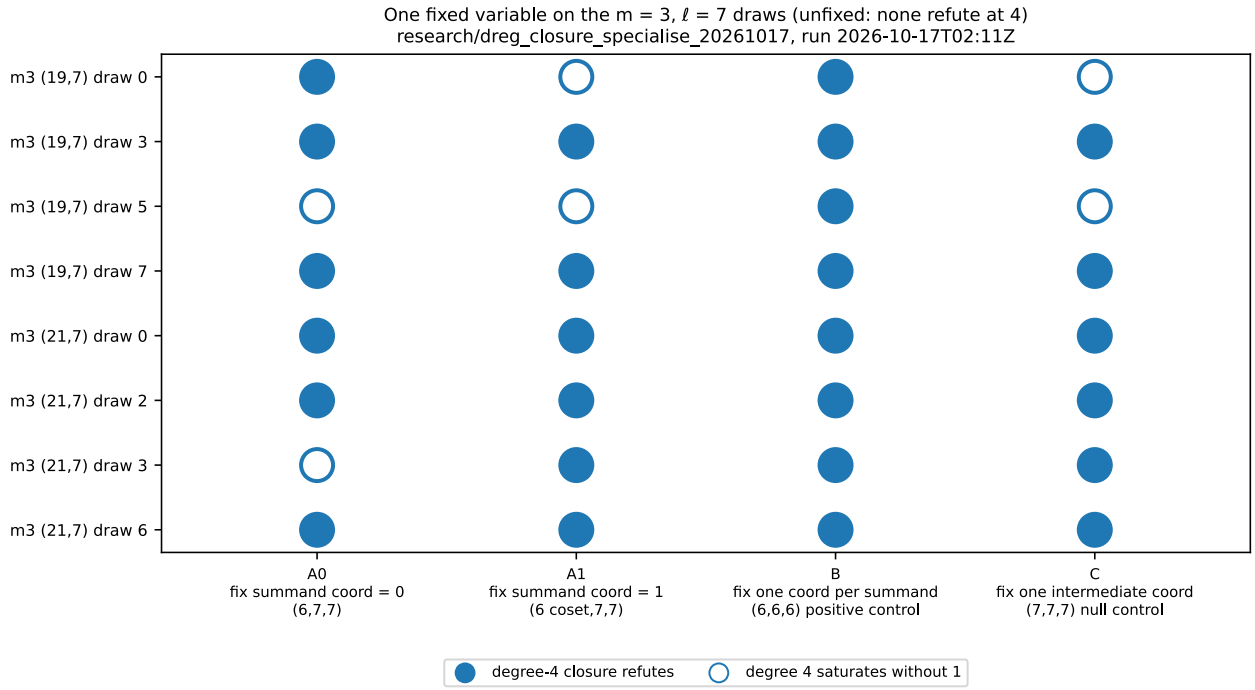


Figure 1: 8 draws × 4 arms, run 2026-10-17T02:11Z.

- **Registered verdict: uninformative for H_sum vs H_max.** The null control C (one intermediate coordinate fixed) refutes on 6 of 8, as often as the discriminating arm A.
- **Descriptive:**
  - Any single fixed variable lets degree 4 refute on 6 of 8 draws. The ℓ = 7 failure at degree 4 is marginal.
  - On 5 of 8 draws, both values of one guessed variable refute. A one-guess hybrid therefore refutes at degree 4, with `C(N−1, ≤4)` ≈ 92k–112k columns per branch against `C(N, ≤5)` ≈ 760k–1M.
- **ECC2K-130 (derived):**
  - Guess-then-degree-4 is a new candidate oracle, `2^k · C(N−k, ≤4)^w`.
  - How k grows with ℓ toward the priced ℓ = 33 is unmeasured. If it is about m·(ℓ−6), it is worse than degree 5.
  - No row moves, and no row beats rho.
- **Next:** the number of guesses needed at ℓ = 8, which sits at this host's memory limit; and m = 4, ℓ = 6 on a larger host.